

Kirti Bhardwaj

GoCardless, London — *Tech Lead & Software Engineer*

March 2020 - Current

Distributed Systems, Scalability and Performance

- **Co-engineered the Postgres to YugabyteDB migration** for GoCardless's core payments monolith (**10M payments on peak days**), so it can scale horizontally.
- **Made the migration pipeline 25x faster** for our **14 TB** dataset (**600 hours down to 24**) by reworking the schema, tuning the database, and digging into YugabyteDB Voyager's partition filtering and CDC replication issues.
- **Designed and shipped a Postgres function to replace direct pg_locks queries** in our job system, unblocking 21 high-volume job classes for the YugabyteDB migration. Validated it against both databases, then rolled it out behind a feature flag (5% to 100%) with a latency probe watching production. **Lock lookup went from ~100ms to ~3ms and P99 latency halved.**
- **Led a cross-team E2E testing effort** to catch edge cases in legacy services, built dry-run tooling with automated fallbacks, rehearsed the cutover repeatedly in production-parallel environments, and agreed readiness criteria with stakeholders for a zero-downtime switch.
- Run **Game Days** to find gaps in our systems, write the runbooks the wider team uses, and onboard engineers inside and outside the team so no one person is a single point of failure.

Product Engineering (Tech Lead)

- **Tech lead for Digital Experience:** led a team across product, engineering and marketing, acting as product owner, engineering lead and main point of contact for stakeholders. Set the technical direction for a marketing platform with 3M+ monthly visitors and mentored engineers.
- **Owned the merchant sign-up redesign end to end**, across frontend and backend. More than half of merchants dropped out at the top of the funnel because we asked for too much upfront, so I cut the first step down to the essentials and A/B tested each change in Optimizely. **Activation went up 22%.**
- Asking for less upfront meant catching spam another way, so I **built email verification** (schema, API, localised templates, SendGrid quality checks), pwned-password checks, rate limiting, reCAPTCHA and device-ID tracking, updated our spam-detection ML model, and passed spam signals downstream so fake accounts were blocked automatically. This removed a recurring source of incidents.
- **Scoped and planned the referral rewards system** for international growth campaigns, including the technical approach, Optimizely experiments and lifecycle messaging through Braze, then handed it to the team to build with ongoing tech guidance.
- **Planned and led frontend delivery of the company-wide website rebrand**, including scoping, prioritisation and stakeholder updates, and moved our content platform from Prismic to Contentful.
- **Built the monorepo template** (TypeScript, Next.js, React, Lerna) that every new UI project starts from, shrank bundle sizes, raised test coverage to 95%, and contributed to Flux, our component library.
- Cut build times from **60 to 15 minutes** and infrastructure costs by **87%**, and moved services from CircleCI to GitHub Actions, AWS to GCS, and Helm to our internal deploy tooling (Utopia).
- Connected **GA, BigQuery and Looker** so marketing could attribute results across channels.

KobiTab — *Founder*

February 2026 - Current

- Built and launched a **household brain for macOS** that pulls a family's scattered files, calendars, emails and notes into one place and turns them into actionable tasks.
- Designed it local-first: indexing and search run on-device with no account needed, and AI is optional, so users can bring their own provider or keep inference fully local.
- Built review-before-run agents for everyday family admin like calendar drafting, nanny coordination and chores, plus plain-language answers with cited sources (e.g. shoe sizes, vaccine records).
- Grown to **2,000 users** organically through word of mouth, with no paid marketing.

PAST EXPERIENCE

Walmart Labs — Software Engineer

Engineered the Fitment auto-parts widget using React, Redux, Node.js, and Hapi.js, increasing Add-To-Cart (ATC) conversion by **9%**.

Automated backend registry services, implementing custom caching layers and integrating with Centralized Configuration Management (CCM) to improve system throughput.

Mentored peers and team on code quality, state management, and testing best practices.

Radiolocus, Mumbai and Bangalore — Tech Lead

Led a cross-functional team of 3 frontend engineers and 1 product designer, driving technical roadmap planning, sprint execution, and UI architecture.

Architected core web applications, establishing frontend performance standards, component libraries, and automated testing patterns across the team.

Mentored junior engineers and partnered with product design to streamline developer-designer handoffs, accelerating feature delivery cadences.

Get Jugaad, India — Co-Founder

Co-founded an urban logistics and ridesharing platform for high-density Indian markets while at university; selected as India's official startup in Steve Blank's Lean Startup Initiative to pitch to Silicon Valley investors.

Led customer discovery, MVP product design, and initial market entry strategy, building foundational product strategy and prototyping skills straight out of university.

Wound it down after hitting a regulatory wall: at the time, Indian law didn't allow charging for rides in privately registered vehicles.

Side Projects

Knowledge-base — A zero-dependency **CLI** tool for organizing project context in markdown. Designed for both human readability and efficient AI agent navigation, featuring automated indexing and lifecycle management.

Wodehouse-gpt — A raw PyTorch, character-level GPT-style transformer built without pre-trained models or Hugging Face, trained on classic literary prose.

Calliope Canvas — A TypeScript/React framework for building code-driven, interactive technical presentations.

Session Manager — A session and bookmark manager utility for different browsers currently live in chrome and firefox app stores